

PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · STRUCTURE

list-steps

Vertical sequence of steps, each with full description body.

What happens in the first hour of an incident, in theory.

STEP 01

Declare and page

Whoever notices opens the incident channel and pages on-call. Declaring is cheap; a missed page is the line item in the post-mortem.

STEP 02

Assign a commander

One person owns coordination and communication. They direct the response — they do not debug it, though they will be asked why they aren't.

STEP 03

Stop the bleeding

Mitigate before diagnosing. Roll back, fail over, or shed load first; find the root cause once customers are safe and the board has logged off.

STEP 04

Communicate on a clock

A status update every 30 minutes, even when it is "still investigating." Silence is what the retrospective remembers.

Three phases, vertically arranged.

STEP 01

Discover

Interview eight stakeholders. Open questions only — listening for friction, not confirming the assumptions we arrived with.



STEP 02

Frame

Half-day workshop to align on root cause. Output is a ranked problem statement and a request for a second workshop.



STEP 03

Decide

Written sign-off on what is in scope, what is out, and what requires a separate decision we will defer.

A four-phase engagement model.

PHASE 01

Discovery

Eight weeks. Stakeholder interviews, current-state audit, and a problem-framing workshop produce a signed scope nobody rereads.

PHASE 02

Design

Six weeks. Two design partners co-build the operating model and the change-management plan that survives until contact with the org.

PHASE 03

Pilot

Twelve weeks. One business unit runs the model end-to-end with weekly retrospectives held biweekly.

PHASE 04

Rollout

Phased by region. Pilot learnings shape the rollout cadence; the central team owns the playbook and the pager.

Three milestones to GA.

MILESTONE A

Closed beta

Five design-partner accounts live on the platform. Daily standups; weekly retros; one account that actually logs in.

MILESTONE B

Open beta

Self-serve signup at the marketing site. Pricing visible but not enforced, which everyone treats as the real pricing.

MILESTONE C

GA

Billing enforcement on. SLA enters effect. Support escalation paths published, then immediately bypassed by the Slack DM.

Three tracks for the next quarter.

STEP A

Platform hardening

Multi-tenant adapters, automated rotation, and the deprovision runbook nobody has had to run land in this track.

STEP B

Compliance posture

Examiner pack v2 and the centralised audit log ship for the Q3 audit window, give or take a window.

STEP C

Developer surface

Polyglot SDK parity and the new CLI flags close out an API roadmap that reopens every quarter.

Three stages, with explicit stage prefixes.

STAGE 01

Plan

Define the work and the artifacts each stage produces.



STAGE 02

Execute

Run the work against the plan; track variance.



STAGE 03

Review

Compare actuals to plan; capture lessons for the next cycle.

Top three risks, ranked by exposure, owned by nobody in particular.

RANK 01

Renewal cohort

\$2.1M ARR at risk if the pricing comp gap persists, which it has, comfortably.

RANK 02

Pipeline conversion

11 pp below Q1; legal review is the chokepoint, as it was last quarter.

RANK 03

Competitive displacement

Seven losses to one competitor in the \$80-200K tier, all to the same deck.

Three engagement tiers.

TIER I

Strategic

Quarterly executive review, dedicated success manager, and a roadmap they are shown but not promised.

TIER II

Growth

Monthly check-in, shared success pool, success defined later.

TIER III

Self-serve

Async docs, community support, and the hope that the docs are current.

Three phases, roman-numeral counter.

PHASE I

Discovery

Identify the constraints and the success criteria.



PHASE II

Design

Sketch options against the constraints; pick one.



PHASE III

Delivery

Build, ship, measure.

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When NOT to reach for list-steps.

Light labels, no body. If each step is a single label with no description, use `timeline`. list-steps earns its chrome only when the body adds substance.

Parallel options. If the rows are alternatives the audience compares, use `cards-grid` or `verdict-grid`. The numbered prefix here reads as sequence — using it for parallel items mis-cues the audience.

Author-typed step numbers. Don't write `<strong>STEP 01</strong>` into the markdown. The badge is CSS-generated from the `ol` counter; manual numbering double-stamps and breaks on reordering.

See also.

RELATED COMPONENTS

- `timeline` — shorter labels per step, horizontal axis instead of vertical cards
- `list-criteria` — gating requirements rather than a sequence of actions
- `split-steps` — phase label + heading on the left, steps on the right
- `roadmap` — phased grid across multiple workstreams
- `principles` — tenets or values rather than a procedural sequence